thought and feeling; yogic awareness produced by contemplative insight into the truth. Perception relates to the unique, momentary particulars (***svalakshana***). They alone are objectively real because reality means the capacity for causal effectiveness (***arthakriya***). Generalising conceptualisation (***samanya-lakshana***) is distanced from the unique instants and is a type of inference. Sensory awareness leads to knowledge when it is truly related to the object. Sensation of a blue object (that is, impressions derived from unique particulars which have the power to produce the experience of blue) produces a dual awareness comprising a blue mental image (*akara*) and consciousness of the blue mental image. The image copies the impressions and the constructive mind, conditioned by traces of prior experiences (***vasana***), interprets the image by applying a concept (***vikalpa***) that enables us to think, act and communicate. While some complex concepts ultimately derive from sensory impressions and mental images formed from them, others, including those of the persisting soul and real cause–effect relations, are produced by the creative imagination.

Realists, such as followers of ***Nyaya*** and ***Vaisheshika***, make the mistake of supposing that our conceptual schemes are direct copies of objectively real structures and entities.

See ***adhyavasaya***

Further reading: Dunne 2004; Kajiyama 1998; Mookerjee 1975

Dharma Shastras: catalogues of rules delineating a pure way of life for Hindus who understand themselves as following the orthodox *Vedic* tradition. They offer an exhaustive and detailed specification of right actions for members of the different castes (although the law books are chiefly concerned with the obligations of Brahmins).